

Question 1 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of Human Resource Development (HRD) and state its major objectives.

Introduction

Imagine an organisation as a living body. Machines, money and buildings are like bones and tools — they have a fixed capacity. People are different: a worker who joins as a trainee can, over years, become a supervisor, a manager, or an innovator. Human Resource Development (HRD) is the planned, continuous process by which an organisation helps its people grow in knowledge, skill, attitude and potential, and at the same time builds a culture in which people help each other.

HRD is a part of Human Resource Management, but it is not the whole of HRM. HRM also includes hiring, salary, labour laws and welfare. HRD specifically deals with learning and development. Leonard Nadler introduced the term HRD in 1969 in the United States. He defined HRD as organised learning experiences, conducted within a specified time, designed to bring about the possibility of behavioural change. In simple words: HRD is not accidental learning; it is planned teaching and practice so that people actually behave differently at work.

Prof. T.V. Rao, who developed the HRD idea strongly in India, said HRD is a process by which employees are helped in a continuous and planned way to (i) acquire or sharpen capabilities for present and future roles, (ii) develop their general capabilities and inner potential, and (iii) develop a culture of teamwork, trust and collaboration. HRD is therefore a process, not a one-day training camp. Techniques such as performance appraisal, counselling, training and organisation development are only tools to keep this process alive.

Healthy organisations use both formal HRD (classroom training, courses, planned change) and informal HRD (a boss coaching a junior). The focus of all HRD is to develop a superior workforce so that both the organisation and the individual can achieve their goals in service to customers.

Detailed points

- 1. Meaning and nature of HRD.** HRD means developing the human side of the enterprise. It covers training after a person is hired, opportunities to learn new skills, resources that help employees do their tasks, coaching, mentoring, career development, performance management, succession planning, tuition help and organisation development. Unlike raw material, human potential is relatively unlimited — but it appears only if the organisation creates a climate that identifies, nurtures and uses that potential. If that climate is missing, even talented people remain unused.
- 2. Objective — capabilities for present and future roles.** The first major objective is to help employees acquire or sharpen the knowledge, skills and attitudes needed for the job they do today and the job they may do tomorrow. Example: a salesman may need product knowledge today; next year the same person may need team-leading skill. HRD plans for both. Without this objective, people become outdated when technology or markets change.
- 3. Objective — developing inner potential and the whole person.** HRD is not only ‘fix the current skill gap’. It also aims to help individuals discover talents they themselves may not have noticed — communication, problem-solving, creativity, leadership — and use them for personal growth and organisational development. This is why career talks, potential appraisal and education (not only job training) are part of HRD.
- 4. Objective — building a developmental culture.** T.V. Rao stressed culture: strong superior–subordinate relations, teamwork and collaboration among departments, so that employees feel professional pride and motivation. If culture is political or fearful, training will not transfer to the job. So culture-building is itself an HRD objective, not a side effect.
- 5. Objective — equity, employability and adaptability.** Notes also list equity (fair chance of training and promotion irrespective of caste, gender, language), employability (skills that keep a person valuable in the labour market), and adaptability (ability to adjust to continuous organisational change). These three make HRD socially

responsible as well as business-useful.

6. Objective — development at many levels, not only the individual. HRD goals include developing: (1) each person as an individual, (2) the person in the present role, (3) the person in future roles, (4) the dyad (employee and boss), (5) team spirit in every unit, (6) collaboration across units, and (7) the organisation's overall health and self-renewing capability. A student should remember that HRD is not 'send staff to a course'; it is multi-level development.

7. Objective — enabling climate and organisational dynamism. Organisations that want to be dynamic and growth-oriented need an enabling culture — people take initiative, experiment, innovate and make things happen. Even a firm that has stopped growing still needs HRD, because the environment keeps changing. HRD's objective is stability plus renewal through people.

8. How objectives are achieved (process, not a bag of tricks). Objectives are achieved by planning HRD, allocating money and time, and living an HRD philosophy that values human beings. Mechanisms (appraisal, training, OD) must be checked periodically: are they helping development or only creating paperwork? If forms are filled but nobody learns, the mechanism is hindering the process and must be redesigned.

Conclusion. For the exam, define HRD (Nadler + T.V. Rao), stress that it is a continuous planned process, then write 5–7 objectives: present/future capabilities, potential, culture, equity/employability/adaptability, multi-level development, and enabling climate. Close by saying HRD develops both people and the organisation, not training alone.